

Keeping Your Software Updated:

- **Automatic Updates:** Ensure that your antivirus software is set to update automatically. This is usually available in the settings menu.
- **Manual Checks:** Periodically check for updates manually to ensure your software is using the most current virus definitions.

Implementing and maintaining antivirus and anti-malware protection is a foundational aspect of securing your devices. By selecting appropriate software, keeping it up to date, and regularly scanning your system, you significantly reduce the risk of malware infections and the potential damage they can cause to your digital life.

After ensuring your software is up to date and your devices are protected against viruses and malware, it's crucial to focus on the security of your mobile devices and the networks they connect to. Mobile devices often carry a wealth of personal information and are frequently used in insecure settings, making them prime targets for cybercriminals. Similarly, the networks you connect to, whether at home or in public, can significantly impact your online safety. This section will guide you through securing your mobile devices and safely using Wi-Fi networks.

Securing Mobile Devices

Mobile devices are central to our daily lives, storing everything from personal photos and messages to financial information and work documents. Ensuring their security is paramount.

Mobile Threats Overview

Mobile threats can come in various forms, including malware, unsecured Wi-Fi connections, phishing attacks, and even physical theft. Each threat requires a specific set of defences to ensure your information remains secure.



Setting Up Screen Locks and Biometrics

One of the simplest yet most effective security measures for a mobile device is to set up a screen lock. This prevents unauthorised access to your device should it fall into the wrong hands.

For Android:

- **Open Settings:** Navigate to the Settings app on your device.
- **Security:** Tap on “Security” or “Lock Screen and Security,” depending on your device.
- **Screen Lock Type:** Select “Screen Lock Type” and choose from options like PIN, pattern, or password. For enhanced security, set a complex password or PIN that is hard to guess.

For iOS:

- **Open Settings:** Go to the Settings app.
- **Face ID & Passcode or Touch ID & Passcode:** Select this option and follow the prompts to set up Face ID, Touch ID, or a passcode, depending on your device's capabilities.

Biometric options like fingerprint scanning and facial recognition offer convenience and an added layer of security. However, always have a strong PIN or password as a backup.

App Permissions and Updates

Apps can request access to various functions and data on your device. Managing these permissions is crucial to protecting your privacy and security.

- **Review Permissions:** Regularly review the permissions granted to each app. On both Android and iOS, you can do this in the Settings app, under “Apps” or “Applications.” Look for permissions that don't seem necessary for the app's function and revoke them if possible.
- **Keeping Apps Updated:** Always update your apps to the latest version to benefit from security patches and improvements. Enable automatic updates in your device's app store settings to streamline this process.

Lost Device Protection

Losing a device or having it stolen can be a significant security risk. Prepare for this possibility in advance by enabling features that can help you recover your device or protect its data.

For Android and iOS:

- **Find My Device/App:** Both Android and iOS offer a “Find My” feature. Enable this in your device's settings to track its location, remotely lock it, display a message, or wipe its data if it's lost or stolen.

Safe Use of Public and Home Wi-Fi Networks

Wi-Fi networks, whether at home or in public, can expose your device to additional risks. Securing these connections is essential for maintaining online safety.